UnitedHealthcare Pharmacy
Clinical Pharmacy Programs

Program Number	2026 P 2297-7
Program	Prior Authorization/Medical Necessity
Medication	Sotyktu™ (deucravacitinib)
P&T Approval Date	1/2023, 4/2023, 7/2023, 7/2024, 10/2024, 10/2025, 4/2026
Effective Date	7/1/2026

1. Background:

Sotyktu is a tyrosine kinase 2 (TYK2) inhibitor indicated for the treatment of adults with moderate to severe plaque psoriasis who are candidates for systemic therapy or phototherapy. *Limitations of Use:* Not recommended for use in combination with other potent immunosuppressants. Sotyktu is also indicated for the treatment of active psoriatic arthritis in adults.

2. Coverage Criteria[a]:

A. Plaque Psoriasis

1. **Initial Authorization**

a. **Sotyktu** will be approved based on **all** of the following criteria:

(1) Diagnosis of moderate to severe plaque psoriasis

-AND-

(2) **One** of the following:

(a) **All** of the following:

i. Greater than or equal to 3% body surface area involvement, palmoplantar, facial, genital involvement, or severe scalp psoriasis

-AND-

ii. History of failure to **one** of the following topical therapies, unless contraindicated or clinically significant adverse effects are experienced (document drug, date, and duration of trial):

a. Corticosteroids (e.g., betamethasone, clobetasol, desonide)
b. Vitamin D analogs (e.g., calcitriol, calcipotriene)
c. Tazarotene
d. Calcineurin inhibitors (e.g., tacrolimus, pimecrolimus)
e. Anthralin
f. Coal tar

-AND-

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iii. History of failure to a 3 month trial of methotrexate at maximally indicated dose, unless contraindicated or clinically significant adverse effects are experienced (document date and duration of trial)[b]

-OR-

(b) Patient has been previously treated with a systemic targeted immunomodulator FDA-approved for the treatment of plaque psoriasis as documented by claims history or submission of medical records (Document drug, date, and duration of therapy) [e.g., adalimumab, Bimzelx (bimekizumab-bkzx), Cimzia (certolizumab), Cosentyx (secukinumab), Enbrel (etanercept), Ilumya (tildrakizumab), Otezla (apremilast), Skyrizi (risankizumab), Siliq (brodalumab), Taltz (ixekizumab), Tremfya (guselkumab), ustekinumab]

-OR-

(c) **Both** of the following:

i. Patient is currently on Sotyktu therapy as documented by claims history or submission of medical records (Document date and duration of therapy)

-AND-

ii. Patient has **not** received a manufacturer supplied sample at no cost in the prescriber's office, or any form of assistance from a manufacturer sponsored program (e.g., sample card which can be redeemed at a pharmacy for a free supply of medication) as a means to establish as a current user of Sotyktu*

-AND-

(3) Patient is not receiving Sotyktu in combination with another systemic targeted immunomodulator [e.g., adalimumab, Bimzelx (bimekizumab-bkzx), Cimzia (certolizumab), Cosentyx (secukinumab), Enbrel (etanercept), Ilumya (tildrakizumab), Otezla (apremilast), Skyrizi (risankizumab), Siliq (brodalumab), Taltz (ixekizumab), Tremfya (guselkumab), ustekinumab] for treatment of the same indication

-AND-

(4) Prescribed by or in consultation with a dermatologist

* Patients requesting initial authorization who were established on therapy via the receipt of a manufacturer supplied sample at no cost in the prescriber's office or any form of assistance from a manufacturer sponsored program **shall be required** to meet initial authorization criteria as if patient were new to therapy.

Authorization will be issued for 12 months.

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2. **Reauthorization**

a. **Sotyktu** will be approved based on **all** of the following criteria:

(1) Documentation of positive clinical response to Sotyktu therapy

-AND-

(2) Patient is not receiving Sotyktu in combination with another systemic targeted immunomodulator [e.g., adalimumab, Bimzelx (bimekizumab-bkzx), Cimzia (certolizumab), Cosentyx (secukinumab), Enbrel (etanercept), Ilumya (tildrakizumab), Otezla (apremilast), Skyrizi (risankizumab), Siliq (brodalumab), Taltz (ixekizumab), Tremfya (guselkumab), ustekinumab] for treatment of the same indication

Authorization will be issued for 12 months.

B. Psoriatic Arthritis (PsA)

1. **Initial Authorization**

a. **Sotyktu** will be approved based on **all** of the following criteria:

(1) Diagnosis of active psoriatic arthritis

-AND-

(1) **One** of the following:

(a) History of failure to a 3 month trial of methotrexate at the maximally indicated dose, unless contraindicated or clinically significant adverse effects are experienced (document date and duration of trial)[b]

-OR-

(b) Patient has been previously treated with a systemic targeted immunomodulator FDA-approved for the treatment of psoriatic arthritis as documented by claims history or submission of medical records (Document drug, date, and duration of therapy) [e.g., adalimumab, Bimzelx (bimekizumab-bkzx), Cimzia (certolizumab), Cosentyx (secukinumab), Enbrel (etanercept), Orencia (abatacept), Otezla (apremilast), Rinvoq (upadacitinib), Simponi (golimumab), Skyrizi (risankizumab), Taltz (ixekizumab), Tremfya (guselkumab), Xeljanz/Xeljanz XR (tofacitinib), ustekinumab]

-OR-

(c) **Both** of the following:

i. Patient is currently on Sotyktu therapy as documented by claims history or submission of medical records (Document date and duration of therapy):

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-AND-

ii. Patient has **not** received a manufacturer supplied sample at no cost in the prescriber's office, or any form of assistance from a manufacturer sponsored program (e.g., sample card which can be redeemed at a pharmacy for a free supply of medication) as a means to establish as a current user of Sotyktu*

-AND-

(3) Patient is not receiving Sotyktu in combination with another systemic targeted immunomodulator [e.g., adalimumab, Bimzelx (bimekizumab-bkzx), Cimzia (certolizumab), Cosentyx (secukinumab), Enbrel (etanercept), Orencia (abatacept), Otezla (apremilast), Rinvoq (upadacitinib), Simponi (golimumab), Skyrizi (risankizumab), Taltz (ixekizumab), Tremfya (guselkumab), Xeljanz/Xeljanz XR (tofacitinib), ustekinumab] for treatment of the same indication

-AND-

(4) Prescribed by or in consultation with **one** of the following:

(a) Rheumatologist
(b) Dermatologist

***** Patients requesting initial authorization who were established on therapy via the receipt of a manufacturer supplied sample at no cost in the prescriber's office or any form of assistance from a manufacturer sponsored program **shall be required** to meet initial authorization criteria as if patient were new to therapy.

Authorization will be issued for 12 months.

2. **Reauthorization**

a. **Sotyktu** will be approved based on **all** of the following criteria:

(1) Documentation of positive clinical response to Sotyktu therapy

-AND-

(2) Patient is not receiving Sotyktu in combination with another systemic targeted immunomodulator [e.g., adalimumab, Bimzelx (bimekizumab-bkzx), Cimzia (certolizumab), Cosentyx (secukinumab), Enbrel (etanercept), Orencia (abatacept), Otezla (apremilast), Rinvoq (upadacitinib), Simponi (golimumab), Skyrizi (risankizumab), Taltz (ixekizumab), Tremfya (guselkumab), Xeljanz/Xeljanz XR (tofacitinib), ustekinumab] for treatment of the same indication

Authorization will be issued for 12 months.

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[a] State mandates may apply. Any federal regulatory requirements and the member specific benefit plan coverage may also impact coverage criteria. Other policies and utilization management programs may apply.
[b] For Connecticut, Kentucky and Mississippi business only a 30-day trial will be required.

3. Additional Clinical Rules:

- Notwithstanding Coverage Criteria, UnitedHealthcare may approve initial and re-authorization based solely on previous claim/medication history, diagnosis codes (ICD-10) and/or claim logic. Use of automated approval and re-approval processes varies by program and/or therapeutic class.
- Supply limits may be in place.

4. Reference:

1. Sotyktu [package insert]. Princeton, NJ: Bristol-Myers Squibb Company; March 2026
2. Menter A, Strober BE, Kaplan DH, et al. Joint AAD-NPF guidelines of care for the management and treatment of psoriasis with biologics. J Am Acad Dermatol. 2019;80:1029-72.
3. Menter A, Korman NJ, Elmets CA,Feldman SR, Gelfand JM, Gordon KB, Guidelines of care for the management of psoriasis and psoriatic arthritis: section 6. Guidelines of care for the treatment of psoriasis and psoriatic arthritis: case-based presentations and evidence-based conclusions. J Am Acad Dermatol. 2011 Jul;65(1):137-74.

Program	Prior Authorization/Medical Necessity - Sotyktu (deucravacitinib)
Change Control	
1/2023	New program
4/2023	Updated step therapy requirement from Humira or Amjevita to one of the preferred adalimumab products and added the footnote "For a list of preferred adalimumab products please reference drug coverage tools."
7/2023	Updated not receiving in combination language to targeted immunomodulator and updated examples.
7/2024	Annual review. Updated step therapy criteria requirements. Updated state mandate foot note.
10/2024	Removed step through preferred products. Added continuation of therapy to initial criteria. Removed preferred adalimumab footnote. Updated examples with no change to clinical intent.
10/2025	Annual review. Updated combination examples and language with no change to clinical intent.
4/2026	Added criteria for active psoriatic arthritis. Updated references.

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